

Apex Systems

Enterprise Data & Integration Engineering

Proposal to	Northwind Retail Group
Request	RFP-2026-017: Customer Data Platform & Marketing Automation Implementation
Supplier	Apex Systems
Submission date	2026-09-10
Validity	90 days from submission

Our understanding of the requirement. Northwind Retail Group (fictional) operates 180 stores and an e-commerce site across five countries. It requires a supplier to implement a Customer Data Platform that unifies roughly 12 million customer profiles from POS, e-commerce, loyalty and the call centre, integrates with the existing SAP ERP and Salesforce Service Cloud, and activates personalised journeys across email, SMS and app push, with GDPR-compliant consent management.

1. Executive Summary

Apex Systems is pleased to respond to Northwind Retail Group's RFP-2026-017. We understand that Northwind needs a single, trusted customer view across POS, e-commerce, loyalty and call-centre data, activated in real time across email, SMS and push, while meeting GDPR obligations in five countries.

Our proposal prioritises architectural robustness and security. We will deliver a cloud-native, event-driven CDP that can scale well beyond Northwind's current 12 million profiles, with enterprise-grade controls independently audited every year. We recognise that our price is above the market average; it reflects a senior engineering team and a platform designed to run for ten years without re-platforming.

2. Proposed Solution and Architecture

The solution uses an event-driven architecture on Microsoft Azure: an Apache Kafka event backbone ingests POS, web, app and loyalty events with sub-second latency; a Delta Lake identity layer performs deterministic and probabilistic identity resolution; and a composable activation layer publishes audiences to email, SMS and push providers through a managed API gateway.

Integrations: we provide 42 pre-built, versioned connectors, including certified connectors for SAP S/4HANA (OData and IDoc) and Salesforce Service Cloud (Platform Events and Bulk API 2.0). All connectors are monitored with automated replay on failure.

Scalability: the platform auto-scales horizontally and has been load-tested at 50 million profiles and 15,000 events per second with p95 profile-lookup latency under 120 ms. Infrastructure is defined as code (Terraform) and deployed through CI/CD pipelines with automated regression tests.

3. Implementation Approach, Timeline and Team

We follow a four-phase delivery over 7 months (30 weeks). Phases overlap where dependencies allow; a formal go/no-go gate precedes production cut-over.

Phase	Weeks	Key milestone
1. Discovery & design	1-6	Solution design authority sign-off
2. Platform build & integrations	7-18	SAP and Salesforce connectors live in test
3. Journeys, testing & UAT	19-26	UAT sign-off, performance test report

Phase	Weeks	Key milestone
4. Cut-over & hypercare	27-30	Go-live, 30-day hypercare exit

Team: 1 engagement lead, 2 solution architects, 6 data/integration engineers, 1 security architect, 2 QA engineers and 1 project manager (13 FTE at peak). Key risks (identity-match quality, SAP data quality) are tracked in a risk log reviewed fortnightly; however, a detailed mitigation plan will be agreed in Phase 1.

4. Commercial Proposal

Pricing is fixed-price for implementation plus annual subscription and support. All figures exclude VAT.

Item	Price (EUR)
Implementation (fixed price, 30 weeks)	780,000
Platform licence & Azure hosting, per year	165,000
Support & maintenance, per year	48,000
Total cost of ownership, 3 years	1,419,000

Assumptions: Northwind provides test data and SAP/Salesforce sandbox access by week 4; up to 12 journey templates are included; change requests are charged at EUR 1,250 per consultant day; licence price is held for 3 years.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Apex Systems holds ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certification and an unqualified SOC 2 Type II report (period ending June 2026), both available under NDA. The solution is hosted exclusively in EU Azure regions (West Europe, Germany West Central).

Controls include AES-256 encryption at rest, TLS 1.3 in transit, customer-managed keys in Azure Key Vault, role-based access with SSO and MFA, field-level pseudonymisation of personal data, and immutable audit logs retained for 7 years and streamed to Northwind's SIEM.

GDPR: we sign Northwind's Data Processing Agreement, maintain a record of processing, support automated data-subject access and erasure requests within 72 hours, and conduct a DPIA with Northwind's DPO in Phase 1. Independent penetration tests are performed before go-live and annually thereafter.

6. Support Model, Experience and References

Support is provided 08:00-18:00 CET on business days, with 24x7 on-call cover for Priority 1 incidents only. P1 response time is 1 hour; P2 is 4 business hours.

Relevant experience: CDP implementations for two European retailers in the last three years. References: Head of Data, Baltic Home Stores (fictional); CIO, Lumen Pharmacy Group (fictional). Contact details provided on request after shortlisting.

All organisations, people, clients and figures in this document are fictional and were created for an academic exercise.